

Whether these dueling murals would be able to happily coexist in the same room was never known, because neither painting was finished. Michelangelo completed a sketch of his composition, but he got no further than that. Leonardo, meanwhile, experimented with how best to prepare his wall for paint. He ended up with a surface that didn't hold the paint well, which halted the project.

It was around this time, in 1506, that Leonardo received an invitation to return to Milan. It was an invitation he was happy to accept, given his fond memories of having lived there for so many years.

In fact, Leonardo bounced back and forth

between Milan and Florence

following the death of his father, Ser Piero, in 1504. Although Leonardo was an illegitimate son, and so inherited nothing himself, he still had a duty to look after his father's estate. However, the focus

